HUMAN RESOURCE DEVELOPMENT

MODULE 4 AND MODULE 5

DETAILED DAVANGERE UNIVERSITY STUDY NOTES

B.Com. – Course Code: B.Com. 3.4.H
Black-and-white printable edition

Syllabus coverage

- Module 4: Training and Development – 12 hours
- Module 5: Recent Trends in HRD – 12 hours
- Simple explanations, workplace examples, key points and examination questions

About These Notes

These notes are prepared using the exact Module 4 and Module 5 topic headings shown in the Davangere University B.Com. Human Resource Development syllabus supplied for this task. Explanations and examples are added in student-friendly language to make the prescribed topics easier to understand. The notes are a study aid, not a verbatim official university publication.

How to prepare: For short answers, learn the meaning and key points. For longer answers, write an introduction, explain the concept under clear headings, add a practical example and finish with a short conclusion.

MODULE 4: TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

Hours prescribed in syllabus: 12

1. Introduction to Training and Development

Meaning of Training

Training is a planned process of teaching employees the knowledge, skills and work-related behaviour needed to perform their present jobs effectively. It focuses mainly on improving the employee's ability to do a particular job.

Example: A newly appointed cashier is trained to use billing software, handle cash, issue receipts and follow cash-control procedures.

Meaning of Development

Development is a broader and longer-term process that prepares employees for future responsibilities, higher positions and changing organisational needs. It improves an individual's overall abilities, judgement, confidence and professional growth.

Example: A company provides leadership, decision-making and strategic-planning programmes to an employee who may become a department manager.

Difference Between Training and Development

Basis	Training	Development
Focus	Present job	Future roles and overall growth
Purpose	Improve specific job performance	Prepare for wider responsibilities
Time period	Usually short or medium term	Usually long term and continuous
Orientation	Job-oriented	Career- and person-oriented
Example	Learning to operate accounting software	Preparing an employee to become a finance manager

Meaning of Education

Education is a systematic process of acquiring general knowledge, concepts, values and understanding. It usually takes place through schools, colleges, universities and other learning institutions. Education builds a foundation, while training develops job-related ability and development prepares a person for future growth.

Difference Between Education, Training and Development

Basis	Education	Training	Development
Main aim	Build general knowledge	Improve current job skills	Prepare for future responsibilities
Scope	Broad	Specific	Broad and long-term
Example	B.Com. degree	Training in Tally	Leadership development programme

Importance of Training and Development

- Improves employee knowledge, skills and job performance.

- Reduces mistakes, accidents, wastage and supervision requirements.
- Improves quality, productivity and customer service.
- Helps employees adjust to new technology, systems and procedures.
- Builds confidence, motivation and job satisfaction.
- Prepares employees for promotion and higher responsibilities.
- Supports organisational growth and competitiveness.

2. Scope of Training

The scope of training refers to the areas and activities in which employees may need learning and improvement. Training is not limited to newly recruited employees; it may be required at every level and throughout an employee's career.

- Induction training: introducing new employees to the organisation, rules, people and workplace.
- Job or technical training: teaching the knowledge and practical skills required for a particular job.
- Safety training: teaching safe work practices and emergency procedures.
- Soft-skills training: improving communication, teamwork, time management and interpersonal skills.
- Supervisory and managerial training: developing planning, delegation, leadership and decision-making.
- Quality and customer-service training: improving service standards and product quality.
- Digital and technology training: teaching employees to use new software, equipment and digital systems.
- Compliance and ethics training: explaining workplace rules, professional conduct and applicable legal requirements.

3. Training Need Analysis (TNA)

Meaning

Training Need Analysis is the systematic process of identifying the gap between the knowledge or skills employees currently have and the knowledge or skills they need to perform their jobs effectively. It helps an organisation decide who needs training, what training is required and why.

Example: A retail company notices that customers are complaining because sales employees cannot explain product features. TNA identifies product knowledge and communication as training needs.

Objectives of TNA

- Identify the actual training gaps instead of arranging training without a clear purpose.
- Determine which employees or departments need training.
- Select suitable training content and methods.
- Use the training budget effectively.
- Improve employee performance and organisational results.
- Provide a basis for evaluating training effectiveness.

Levels of Training Need Analysis

Level	What is examined?	Example
Organisational analysis	Organisation's goals, strategy, resources and performance problems.	A company plans to introduce digital operations and needs digital-skills training.
Task or job analysis	Duties, responsibilities and skills required for a particular job.	A cashier must know billing, cash handling and customer interaction.
Individual analysis	An employee's present performance and the gap between expected and actual performance.	An employee needs Excel training after a skills assessment.

Steps in TNA

- Identify the organisational problem or performance objective.
- Collect information through observation, interviews, questionnaires, performance reports and discussions.
- Study the organisation, job requirements and individual employees.
- Compare existing skills with the skills required.
- Identify the causes of the gap and confirm whether training can solve it.
- Set training priorities and objectives.
- Recommend the training content, method, participants and schedule.

Methods Used to Identify Training Needs

- Observation of employees while they perform their jobs.
- Interviews with employees, supervisors and managers.
- Questionnaires and employee surveys.
- Performance appraisal reports.
- Customer complaints and quality reports.
- Skill tests, work samples and job-knowledge tests.
- Changes in technology, law, products or organisational strategy.

Important point: Not every performance problem can be solved by training. A lack of equipment, unclear instructions, unrealistic targets or poor working conditions may require a different solution.

4. Types of Training: Internal and External

Internal Training

Internal training is organised and conducted within the organisation, using its own managers, supervisors, trainers, facilities or work systems.

Example: A senior accountant trains newly recruited accounts assistants in the company's accounting procedures.

- Advantages: training can be designed around the organisation's actual work; it may be less expensive; employees learn familiar procedures; schedules can be flexible.
- Limitations: internal trainers may lack specialist knowledge; employees may learn only existing practices; work may be interrupted; facilities may be limited.

External Training

External training is provided by an outside institution, professional trainer, consultancy, college, industry association or specialist training centre.

Example: A company sends its HR executives to a professional institute for a programme on labour-law updates.

- Advantages: access to specialist trainers and updated knowledge; exposure to different organisations and ideas; useful for specialised subjects.
- Limitations: fees and travel may be high; content may not fully match the organisation's needs; employees may need help applying what they learned to their jobs.

Difference Between Internal and External Training

Basis	Internal training	External training
Location	Within the organisation	Outside or through an external provider
Trainer	Company manager, supervisor or internal trainer	External expert or institution
Cost	Often comparatively economical	May involve fees, travel and accommodation
Content	Can be closely linked to company procedures	May offer wider or specialised knowledge
Example	In-house software demonstration	External certification programme

5. Outbound Training

Meaning

Outbound training is a learning method in which employees participate in structured activities outside the usual workplace, often in an outdoor or unfamiliar setting. Activities are designed to develop teamwork, leadership, communication, trust, planning and problem-solving.

Example: A group of employees takes part in a supervised team challenge that requires them to plan, communicate and complete a task together.

Objectives

- Develop teamwork and cooperation.
- Improve leadership and decision-making.
- Build trust among team members.
- Improve communication and listening.
- Develop problem-solving and planning skills.
- Build confidence and adaptability.

Common Outbound Training Activities

- Team-building games and group challenges.
- Obstacle-course activities conducted with appropriate safety arrangements.
- Problem-solving tasks and treasure hunts.
- Group planning and outdoor projects.
- Reflection and discussion sessions after activities.

Advantages and Limitations

- Advantages: experiential learning, active participation, stronger relationships and an opportunity to observe team behaviour.
- Limitations: weather, safety, accessibility and cost may be concerns; activities must be linked to learning objectives and followed by reflection.

Key point: Outbound training is not simply an outing or recreational event. It must have planned learning objectives, suitable supervision and a discussion connecting the activity to workplace behaviour.

6. Attitudinal Training

Meaning

Attitudinal training aims to develop positive work-related attitudes, values and behaviour. It helps employees develop a constructive approach towards work, customers, colleagues, change and organisational responsibilities.

Example: Employees who respond rudely to customer complaints may attend a programme on empathy, patience, service attitude and professional communication.

Objectives

- Develop a positive attitude towards work.
- Encourage discipline, responsibility and punctuality.
- Improve customer orientation and service behaviour.
- Promote respect, cooperation and teamwork.
- Develop openness to feedback and organisational change.
- Encourage ethical conduct and accountability.

Methods of Attitudinal Training

- Role play: employees practise responding to realistic workplace situations.
- Case studies: participants discuss situations involving attitude and behaviour.
- Group discussion: employees share views and learn from different perspectives.
- Behavioural modelling: a trainer demonstrates suitable behaviour for participants to practise.
- Self-assessment and feedback: participants identify strengths and areas for improvement.
- Counselling and coaching: individuals receive guidance to improve work attitudes.

Importance

Attitudinal training can improve workplace relationships, customer service, employee morale and cooperation. However, training alone cannot create a positive culture if organisational policies and management behaviour contradict the values being taught.

7. Principles Involved in Selection of a Training Method

A training method should be selected according to the learning objective, nature of the job, participants and available resources. One method is not suitable for every training need.

- Training objectives: select a method that helps achieve the specific learning outcome.
- Nature of the job: practical jobs may require demonstration and hands-on practice; conceptual subjects may need discussion or case studies.
- Participants' level: consider age, education, experience, language and existing knowledge.
- Number of trainees: a lecture may suit a large group, while coaching may suit an individual or small group.
- Cost and budget: consider trainer fees, materials, travel, equipment and time away from work.
- Time available: choose a method that fits the training schedule without reducing learning quality.
- Trainer competence: ensure the trainer can use the selected method effectively.
- Learning by doing: provide opportunities to practise and receive feedback wherever possible.
- Transfer to the job: choose methods that help employees apply learning at work.
- Evaluation: select a method whose results can be assessed against the training objectives.
- Safety and accessibility: ensure activities are safe, inclusive and suitable for participants.

8. Techniques of Training at Different Levels

Training techniques differ according to the responsibilities and experience of employees. Operational employees need practical job skills, supervisors need people-management skills, and managers need wider planning and decision-making abilities.

A. Training for Workers / Operational Employees

- On-the-job training: learning while performing the actual job under guidance.
- Demonstration: trainer shows the correct way to operate equipment or perform a task.

- Job instruction training: work is explained step by step, demonstrated, practised and reviewed.
- Apprenticeship: a learner combines practical work experience with structured instruction, often for a skilled trade.
- Simulation: employees practise tasks in a controlled setting that resembles the real work situation.

Example: A production worker learns machine operation by observing a skilled operator and practising under supervision.

B. Training for Supervisors / First-Line Managers

- Role play: practising how to give feedback, resolve disputes or conduct a briefing.
- Case study: analysing employee, quality or production problems.
- Group discussion: learning to coordinate people and share solutions.
- Coaching skills training: learning how to guide and support team members.
- Job rotation: gaining experience in different operational areas.

Example: A new supervisor learns how to allocate duties, monitor attendance and handle a team conflict.

C. Training for Middle and Senior Managers

- Management development programmes: structured programmes in planning, leadership and strategy.
- Business games: teams make simulated business decisions and study their results.
- Case analysis: examining complex business situations and recommending decisions.
- Management by projects: learning through responsibility for a real organisational project.
- Executive coaching and mentoring: individual guidance from experienced leaders.
- Conferences and seminars: learning about industry developments, strategy and management practices.

Example: A department manager participates in a business simulation involving budgeting, competition and resource allocation.

9. Training Effectiveness

Meaning

Training effectiveness refers to the extent to which a training programme achieves its objectives and improves participants' knowledge, skills, behaviour or job performance.

Why Evaluate Training Effectiveness?

- To check whether learning objectives were achieved.
- To find out whether employees can apply new skills at work.
- To identify strengths and weaknesses in the training programme.
- To decide whether the programme should be continued, modified or replaced.
- To understand whether training contributes to organisational results.

Common Evaluation Framework: Four Levels

Level	What is evaluated?	Example
Reaction	Participants' response to the programme.	Did employees find the session useful and relevant?
Learning	Change in knowledge, skills or attitude.	Did test scores or practical skill demonstrations improve?
Behaviour	Application of learning in the workplace.	Are employees using the new customer-service method?
Results	Effect on organisational outcomes.	Have complaints, errors or delays reduced?

Methods of Evaluating Training

- Feedback forms and participant surveys.

- Pre-training and post-training tests.
- Practical demonstrations and skill assessments.
- Observation by supervisors after training.
- Performance appraisal and productivity records.
- Customer feedback, error rates, quality measures and other relevant business indicators.

Steps in Evaluating Training Effectiveness

- Set clear training objectives before the programme.
- Decide what evidence will show that the objectives were achieved.
- Collect information before training to establish a baseline.
- Measure participant reaction and learning during or immediately after training.
- Observe whether employees apply the learning at work.
- Review relevant organisational results.
- Compare results with the objectives and recommend improvements.

Conclusion: Effective training is not measured only by attendance or participant enjoyment. It should be assessed through learning, workplace application and relevant results.

MODULE 5: RECENT TRENDS IN HRD

Hours prescribed in syllabus: 12

This module explains emerging practices and changing priorities in Human Resource Development. Organisations increasingly focus on professional trainers, research, employee awareness, industrial relations, effective use of HRD, technology, coaching, mentoring and competency-based development.

1. Introduction to Recent Trends in HRD

Recent trends in HRD are new approaches, practices and developments used by organisations to improve employee capabilities and organisational performance. HRD is no longer limited to classroom training. It also includes continuous learning, research, technology-enabled learning, coaching, mentoring, competency development and strategic employee engagement.

Major Trends

- Continuous learning and reskilling to keep employees updated.
- Digital learning platforms and technology-supported training.
- Coaching and mentoring for individual development.
- Competency-based HRD and competency mapping.
- Greater use of research and data to plan HRD activities.
- Greater attention to employee engagement, workplace relationships and organisational culture.
- Measurement of training outcomes and business impact.

2. Training for Trainers and HRD Professionals

Meaning

Training for trainers means developing the knowledge and skills of people who deliver training. HRD professionals are employees who plan, coordinate, implement and evaluate human resource development activities. They need professional capabilities to understand employee needs and design effective learning programmes.

Why Trainers Need Training

- To improve subject knowledge and training skills.
- To learn how adults learn and how to involve participants.
- To use suitable teaching methods, activities and learning materials.
- To manage groups and handle questions effectively.
- To evaluate whether participants have learned.
- To use digital tools and blended learning methods.

Important Competencies of an Effective Trainer

Competency	Explanation
Subject knowledge	Understands the topic and can explain it accurately.
Communication	Explains concepts clearly and listens to participants.
Facilitation	Encourages discussion, questions and participation.
Instructional design	Plans objectives, content, activities and assessment.
Technology skills	Uses digital platforms and presentation tools appropriately.
Assessment	Checks learning and provides useful feedback.
Adaptability	Adjusts the session to participants' needs and learning levels.

Training Required for HRD Professionals

- Training need analysis and HRD planning.
- Learning design, facilitation and evaluation.
- Performance management and competency mapping.
- Employee engagement and organisational development.
- Employment relations, ethics and applicable legal requirements.
- HR analytics, digital HR tools and learning management systems.

Example: An HR executive who coordinates employee training attends a programme on identifying training needs, preparing learning objectives and measuring training results.

3. Promoting Research in HRD

Meaning

Research in HRD is the systematic collection and analysis of information to understand employee development, workplace learning, organisational behaviour and the effectiveness of HRD practices. Research helps organisations make decisions based on evidence rather than assumptions.

Objectives of HRD Research

- Identify employee learning and development needs.
- Understand factors affecting employee performance and motivation.
- Evaluate the effectiveness of training programmes.
- Study organisational climate, culture and employee behaviour.
- Identify new HRD practices and emerging skill requirements.
- Improve HRD policies and organisational decision-making.

Areas of Research in HRD

- Training needs and learning preferences.
- Employee engagement, motivation and job satisfaction.
- Leadership development and succession planning.
- Workplace learning and knowledge sharing.
- Impact of technology and digital learning.
- Training effectiveness and return on investment.
- Competency requirements for present and future jobs.

Steps in Conducting HRD Research

- Identify the research problem or question.
- Review relevant information and previous studies.
- Set research objectives.
- Select a suitable method, such as survey, interview, observation or case study.
- Collect information ethically and accurately.
- Analyse the information and identify patterns.
- Draw conclusions and make practical recommendations.
- Share findings and use them to improve HRD practices.

Example: An organisation surveys employees after a training programme, interviews supervisors and compares error rates before and after training to understand whether the programme helped.

4. Creating Awareness and Commitment to HRD

Meaning

Creating awareness of HRD means helping employees and managers understand the purpose, benefits and opportunities of employee development. Creating commitment means encouraging them to actively support and participate in HRD activities.

Why Awareness and Commitment are Important

- Employees may not participate if they do not understand the purpose of training.
- Managers must provide time, support and resources for learning.
- Employees are more likely to apply learning when supervisors encourage them.
- An HRD culture supports continuous improvement and organisational growth.

Methods of Creating Awareness and Commitment

- Communicate HRD policies, objectives and opportunities clearly.
- Conduct orientation sessions and awareness programmes.
- Explain how learning supports employees' careers and organisational goals.
- Obtain visible support from senior management.
- Encourage managers to discuss development during performance reviews.
- Recognise employees who apply new learning and share knowledge.
- Invite employees to give feedback on training needs and programmes.

Example: Before introducing a digital-skills programme, management explains why the new system is needed, how the training will help employees and what support will be available.

5. Industrial Relations and HRD

Meaning of Industrial Relations

Industrial relations refer to the relationship between employers, employees and their representatives, including trade unions, in matters relating to employment, working conditions, communication and workplace cooperation.

Relationship Between Industrial Relations and HRD

HRD can support healthy industrial relations by improving communication, employee skills, supervisor behaviour, trust and participation. Good industrial relations can also create a stable environment in which employees are more willing to learn and contribute.

Role of HRD in Improving Industrial Relations

- Communication training helps managers and employees discuss issues clearly.
- Supervisory development helps managers treat employees fairly and handle grievances.
- Team-building activities improve cooperation between departments and groups.
- Employee education helps workers understand policies, safety and organisational changes.
- Conflict-management training supports constructive resolution of disagreements.
- Participation in problem-solving can build trust and shared responsibility.

Benefits

- Improves understanding between management and employees.
- Can reduce misunderstandings and workplace conflict.
- Encourages cooperation and employee participation.
- Supports productivity and workplace stability.

- Builds a culture of mutual respect.

Example: A company conducts communication and grievance-handling training for supervisors so employee concerns can be heard and addressed fairly.

6. Utilization of HRD Efforts

Meaning

Utilisation of HRD efforts means making proper use of the knowledge, skills, abilities and competencies developed through training and other HRD activities. Training creates value only when employees get opportunities to apply what they have learned.

Ways to Utilise HRD Efforts

- Assign employees duties that allow them to use their newly acquired skills.
- Provide the tools, technology and authority needed to apply learning.
- Encourage supervisors to support and monitor workplace application.
- Use job rotation and project assignments to broaden experience.
- Create opportunities for employees to share knowledge with colleagues.
- Include relevant competencies in performance discussions and career planning.
- Review whether the training is being applied and remove barriers.

Barriers to Utilisation

- Lack of equipment, time or management support.
- Workplace procedures that do not allow employees to use new methods.
- Fear of making mistakes or resistance to change.
- Training content that is not relevant to actual job requirements.
- No follow-up, feedback or opportunity to practise.

Example: An employee trained in advanced spreadsheet skills should be given suitable work assignments and access to the software so that the new skills can be used.

7. Future of HRD

The future of HRD will be influenced by changes in technology, business needs, employee expectations and the nature of work. Organisations will need to support continuous learning and prepare employees for new roles and skills.

Likely Developments and Priorities

- Continuous reskilling and upskilling as job requirements change.
- Greater use of online, mobile and blended learning.
- Personalised learning based on an employee’s role, skill gaps and career goals.
- Use of data and analytics to identify learning needs and evaluate results.
- Greater focus on digital, analytical, communication and problem-solving skills.
- Learning that supports innovation, adaptability and collaboration.
- More attention to employee wellbeing, inclusion and sustainable work practices.
- Closer alignment between HRD strategy and organisational strategy.

Reskilling means learning new skills for a different or changing role. **Upskilling** means improving or extending skills needed in the current or a closely related role.

8. International Comparison of HRD

Meaning

International comparison of HRD means studying and comparing how organisations in different countries develop their employees. It helps organisations understand different training systems, workplace learning practices, leadership approaches and approaches to employee development.

Why Compare HRD Practices Internationally?

- To learn effective training and development practices from other countries.
- To understand how culture and national institutions influence HRD.
- To prepare employees for international assignments and global teamwork.
- To identify global skill requirements and learning trends.
- To improve organisational practices through suitable adaptation.

Areas for Comparison

Area	What can be compared?
Training systems	Workplace training, apprenticeships and professional learning.
Learning culture	Employee responsibility for learning and knowledge sharing.
Leadership development	Methods used to identify and prepare future leaders.
Technology	Use of digital platforms, simulations and learning analytics.
Employee relations	Employee participation, consultation and workplace communication.
Evaluation	How organisations assess training outcomes and performance.

Important Considerations

A practice that works well in one country may not work in exactly the same way in another. Organisations should consider local culture, language, laws, education systems, business conditions and employee expectations before adopting an international practice.

Example: A company operating in India and another country may compare onboarding and technical training methods, then adapt the most suitable practices to each location.

9. Integrating HRD with Technology

Meaning

Integrating HRD with technology means using digital tools and systems to plan, deliver, manage and evaluate employee learning and development.

Examples of Technology Used in HRD

Technology	Use in HRD
Learning Management System (LMS)	Assigns courses, tracks completion and stores learning records.
E-learning platforms	Provide online lessons, videos, quizzes and learning materials.
Video conferencing	Supports live online training and remote workshops.
Simulation and virtual reality	Allows employees to practise selected tasks in a simulated environment.
Mobile learning	Allows employees to access learning through mobile devices.
HR analytics	Helps identify skill gaps and examine training participation and outcomes.

Benefits

- Learning can be accessed across locations and at flexible times.

- Digital content can be updated more easily.
- Learning progress and completion can be tracked.
- Online learning may reduce travel and venue costs.
- Technology can support personalised and self-paced learning.

Challenges

- Employees may have different levels of digital literacy.
- Reliable devices, internet access and technical support are required.
- Online learning may provide less direct interaction.
- Organisations must protect employee data and privacy.
- Content must be engaging, accessible and relevant to the job.

Blended learning combines face-to-face learning with online or digital learning. For example, employees may complete online theory modules and then attend an in-person practical session.

10. Coaching and Mentoring

A. Coaching – Meaning

Coaching is a structured process in which a coach helps an employee improve specific skills, solve work-related challenges or achieve defined performance goals through questions, guidance, practice and feedback.

Example: A sales manager coaches a sales executive on asking better questions, explaining product benefits and responding to customer objections.

Features and Benefits of Coaching

- Usually focuses on specific performance goals or skills.
- May be short-term or ongoing, depending on the need.
- Encourages self-reflection and practical action.
- Provides feedback and helps track progress.
- Can improve confidence, performance and problem-solving.

B. Mentoring – Meaning

Mentoring is a developmental relationship in which a more experienced person (mentor) provides guidance, advice, support and knowledge to a less experienced person (mentee) to support wider professional and career development.

Example: An experienced finance manager guides a newly appointed finance executive about career development, professional conduct and handling responsibilities.

Features and Benefits of Mentoring

- Often focuses on long-term professional and career development.
- Uses the mentor’s experience and knowledge.
- Can support confidence, career planning and organisational understanding.
- Encourages knowledge sharing between experienced and less experienced employees.

Difference Between Coaching and Mentoring

Basis	Coaching	Mentoring
Main focus	Specific performance or skill improvement	Broader professional and career development
Relationship	Often structured around defined goals	Often based on an ongoing developmental relationship
Guide	Coach may be a trained coach or manager	Mentor is usually a more experienced person
Time frame	Often shorter or goal-based	Often longer term
Example	Improving presentation skills	Guidance on long-term career growth

11. Competency Framework of HRD

Meaning of Competency

A competency is a combination of knowledge, skills, abilities and behaviours that enables a person to perform a job or role effectively. Competencies describe not only what a person knows, but also how the person applies that knowledge and behaves at work.

Example: A successful HR executive may need knowledge of recruitment, interviewing skills, communication ability, confidentiality and fair judgement.

Meaning of Competency Framework

A competency framework is an organised structure that identifies the competencies required for different jobs, roles or levels in an organisation. It provides a common reference for recruitment, training, performance management, promotion and career development.

Types of Competencies

Type	Meaning and example
Core competencies	Expected from employees across the organisation, such as integrity, teamwork and communication.
Functional or technical competencies	Required for a particular job or department, such as accounting knowledge for an accountant.
Managerial or leadership competencies	Required for managing people and resources, such as delegation, planning and decision-making.

Importance of a Competency Framework

- Clarifies the knowledge, skills and behaviours required for roles.
- Helps identify employee strengths and development gaps.
- Supports recruitment and selection.
- Guides training and career development.
- Improves performance discussions and succession planning.
- Aligns employee capabilities with organisational objectives.

12. Understanding the Competency Mapping Framework

Meaning of Competency Mapping

Competency mapping is the process of identifying the competencies required for a particular job and comparing them with the competencies an employee currently possesses. It helps identify the gap between required and existing capabilities.

Example: A job requires advanced Excel, report writing and communication. An employee has good communication but only basic Excel skills. The mapping process identifies advanced Excel as a development need.

Steps in Competency Mapping

- Identify the job or role to be studied.
- Understand the duties, responsibilities and expected results of the role.
- Identify the knowledge, skills, abilities and behaviours required.
- Define each competency clearly and describe expected proficiency levels.
- Assess the employee using interviews, tests, observation, work samples or performance evidence.
- Compare the employee's current level with the required level.
- Identify competency gaps and prioritise development needs.
- Prepare an individual development plan with suitable training, coaching, mentoring or work experience.
- Review progress and update the competency map when job requirements change.

Competency Gap – Simple Illustration

Competency	Required level	Employee level	Gap / action
Excel	Advanced	Basic	Provide advanced Excel training and practice.
Communication	Good	Good	Maintain and strengthen through regular use.
Report writing	Good	Developing	Provide writing guidance and feedback.

Competency mapping should be based on actual job requirements and reliable evidence. It should not be treated as a personal judgement or a one-time exercise.

13. Analysing Steps in Competency Mapping

The competency mapping process can be understood as a cycle:

Stage	Main activity	Output
Job study	Study role duties, responsibilities and expected results.	Clear job requirements.
Competency identification	List technical, behavioural and managerial competencies.	Competency profile.
Proficiency definition	Describe basic, intermediate and advanced levels where relevant.	Competency standards.
Assessment	Collect evidence of the employee's current capabilities.	Current competency profile.
Gap analysis	Compare required and current proficiency.	List of competency gaps.
Development planning	Select training, coaching, mentoring or job experience.	Individual development plan.
Review	Reassess progress and update requirements.	Updated competency profile.

14. Balanced Scorecard

Meaning

The Balanced Scorecard is a strategic performance management framework that helps an organisation translate its strategy into objectives and measures. It examines performance from more than one perspective rather than focusing only on financial results. In HRD, it can help connect employee learning and development with internal processes, customer outcomes and financial performance.

Four Perspectives of the Balanced Scorecard

Perspective	Main question	Example measure
Financial	How do our activities affect financial performance?	Training cost, productivity-related savings or return on training investment.
Customer	How do customers view the organisation?	Customer satisfaction, complaints or service ratings.
Internal process	Which internal processes must work well?	Error rate, service time, quality or process efficiency.
Learning and growth	How can the organisation continue to improve?	Employee skills, training completion, engagement and competency levels.

Importance in HRD

- Connects employee learning with organisational strategy.
- Encourages measurement beyond training attendance.
- Shows how skill development may improve processes and customer outcomes.
- Helps managers monitor progress through clear indicators.
- Supports continuous learning and improvement.

Example: A bank may train employees in digital banking. Learning and growth measures may track digital skills; internal-process measures may track transaction errors; customer measures may track satisfaction; and financial measures may track operating efficiency.

15. Appreciative Inquiry

Meaning

Appreciative Inquiry is an approach to organisational development that focuses on identifying and building on an organisation's strengths, successful experiences and positive possibilities. Instead of concentrating only on what is wrong, it asks what is working well and how those strengths can be expanded.

Main Principles

- Focus on strengths and successful practices.
- Encourage participation and shared discussion.
- Use positive questions to discover opportunities.
- Create a shared picture of a desirable future.
- Turn ideas into practical action and continuous improvement.

The 4-D Cycle of Appreciative Inquiry

Stage	Meaning	Example question
Discover	Identify what works well and the organisation's strengths.	When have our teams performed at their best?
Dream	Imagine what the organisation could achieve by building on strengths.	What would an excellent workplace look like?
Design	Plan systems, practices and actions to support the desired future.	What changes would help us achieve that future?
Destiny / Deliver	Implement actions, learn and continue improvement.	How will we put the plan into practice and sustain progress?

Use of Appreciative Inquiry in HRD

- Identifies successful learning and development practices.
- Encourages employee participation and positive communication.
- Builds confidence and shared ownership of change.

• Helps teams design improvements using existing strengths.

Example: Instead of asking only why a department has poor teamwork, a facilitator asks employees to describe a time when teamwork was excellent, identify what made it successful and plan how to repeat those conditions.

Quick Revision – Module 4

Topic	Remember
Training	Planned learning to improve present job performance.
Development	Longer-term growth and preparation for future roles.
Education	Broad learning that builds general knowledge and understanding.
TNA	Identifies the gap between existing and required skills.
Internal training	Training conducted within the organisation.
External training	Training provided by an outside institution or expert.
Outbound training	Structured outside-workplace activities for learning teamwork and other skills.
Attitudinal training	Develops positive work attitudes and behaviour.
Training effectiveness	Measures whether training achieves its objectives and improves performance.

Quick Revision – Module 5

Topic	Remember
Training for trainers	Improves the capabilities of people who deliver training.
HRD research	Systematic study of employee development and HRD practices.
Awareness and commitment	Helping people understand and support HRD.
Industrial relations	Relationships among employers, employees and their representatives.
Utilisation of HRD	Applying acquired skills and knowledge at work.
Future of HRD	Continuous learning, reskilling, digital learning and strategic development.
International comparison	Studying HRD practices across countries and adapting suitable ideas.
Technology integration	Using digital tools to deliver and manage learning.
Coaching	Guidance to improve specific performance or skills.
Mentoring	Guidance for wider professional and career development.
Competency framework	Structure describing competencies required for roles.
Competency mapping	Identifying required competencies and comparing them with current competencies.
Balanced Scorecard	Measures performance through financial, customer, internal-process and learning perspectives.
Appreciative Inquiry	Builds improvement by identifying and expanding strengths.

Important Examination Questions

Module 4 – 2-Mark Questions

• Define training and development.

• What is education?

• Define Training Need Analysis.

• What is internal training? What is external training?

• Define outbound training.

• What is attitudinal training?

- State any two principles for selecting a training method.
- What is training effectiveness?

Module 4 – 6-Mark Questions

- Explain the importance and scope of training.
- Differentiate between education, training and development.
- Explain the levels and steps of Training Need Analysis.
- Differentiate between internal and external training.
- Explain the objectives and activities of outbound training.
- Explain the objectives and methods of attitudinal training.
- Discuss the principles involved in selecting a training method.
- Explain training techniques used at different organisational levels.
- Explain the methods of evaluating training effectiveness.

Module 4 – 10-Mark Questions

- Explain training and development, their importance and scope.
- Define Training Need Analysis and explain its levels, methods and steps.
- Explain internal and external training with advantages and limitations.
- Discuss outbound training and attitudinal training.
- Explain the principles involved in selecting training methods.
- Discuss the techniques of training at worker, supervisory and managerial levels.
- Explain the meaning, importance, methods and steps of evaluating training effectiveness.

Module 5 – 2-Mark Questions

- What is training for trainers?
- Define research in HRD.
- What is meant by creating awareness and commitment to HRD?
- Define industrial relations.
- What is utilisation of HRD efforts?
- Define competency and competency framework.
- What is competency mapping?
- Expand the four perspectives of the Balanced Scorecard.
- What is Appreciative Inquiry?

Module 5 – 6-Mark Questions

- Explain the need for training trainers and HRD professionals.
- Discuss the importance of research in HRD.
- Explain methods of creating awareness and commitment to HRD.
- Explain the role of HRD in improving industrial relations.
- Discuss the utilisation of HRD efforts and barriers to utilisation.
- Explain the role of technology in HRD.
- Differentiate between coaching and mentoring.
- Explain the importance of competency mapping.
- Explain the four perspectives of the Balanced Scorecard.

- Discuss the 4-D cycle of Appreciative Inquiry.

Module 5 – 10-Mark Questions

- Explain recent trends in HRD and discuss the future of HRD.
- Discuss training for trainers and HRD professionals and the importance of research in HRD.
- Explain how organisations can create awareness and commitment to HRD and improve industrial relations.
- Explain the utilisation of HRD efforts and the challenges involved.
- Discuss the integration of HRD with technology, coaching and mentoring.
- Define competency framework and explain the steps involved in competency mapping.
- Explain the Balanced Scorecard and its relevance to HRD.
- Explain Appreciative Inquiry and discuss its 4-D cycle and application in HRD.

Answer-Writing Tips

- For a 2-mark question, write a direct definition and one relevant point or example.
- For a 6-mark question, begin with the meaning and explain about five or six points under headings.
- For a 10-mark question, include an introduction, definition, detailed explanation, examples, advantages or limitations where relevant, and a short conclusion.
- Use tables for comparison questions such as training versus development, internal versus external training, and coaching versus mentoring.
- For process questions, write the steps in the correct sequence.

Final study reminder: The topic headings in these notes follow the Module 4 and Module 5 syllabus. Examples and explanatory detail are included to support classroom teaching and examination preparation.